

EU lawmakers demand stronger industrial policy bill as China threat rises

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By Francesca Micheletti · Sep 2, 2026, 12:19 PM · [View in your browser](#)

BRUSSELS — The three EU lawmakers leading on the Industrial Accelerator Act want to strengthen the European Commission's proposal amid mounting worries over China, Green MEP Anna Cavazzini said in an interview with POLITICO.

"There's a lot of alignment [among the three lead MEPs] that we need to strengthen the Commission proposal," Cavazzini said. The German MEP is a co-lead on the file together with two French lawmakers, socialist Pierre Jouve and Christophe Grudler of the centrist Renew group.

Support for the bloc's first comprehensive industrial policy proposal has been growing since the Commission presented it in March, according to Cavazzini. "The urgency has increased," she said, calling the IAA a "cornerstone" of the EU's response to China's aggressive trade policies.

The IAA aims to boost European industry by introducing a "Made in Europe" criterion for public procurement in certain strategic sectors and strict rules for vetting Chinese investment.

The Parliament may propose to better tailor local content methodology to prevent that Made in Europe criteria from being too easily circumvented, Cavazzini said, for example by Chinese automakers setting up shop in Morocco. But she said that details were still being ironed out ahead of a first draft report that is on track to land next week.

The report will be authored by the three committees jointly responsible for the file in Parliament — IMCO, ITRE and INTA. Cavazzini cautioned that it's too early to say whether the IAA will make it to a plenary vote in December, as tentatively scheduled.

EU institutions have set themselves an ambitious year end target to wrap up the proposal which is part of the bloc's One Europe, One Market roadmap to revive the single market.

Lawmakers will hear from the automotive, steel, chemicals and batteries industries in a public hearing on Wednesday — all sectors that face stiff competition from China.

Cavazzini called the IAA a game changer. "For the first time, we are strategically looking at the demand side and for the first time we are focusing on Europe," she said.

The proposal has raised eyebrows among the bloc's free trade purists and worried friendly trading partners like Canada and Japan.

But Cavazzini said that protectionism isn't what the IAA is about. "It's not about market access," she said. The IAA's aim isn't to introduce new tariffs or restrict the free flow of goods, she said, but rather, about concentrating European taxpayers' money on European companies.

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